

Project Report – Digital Literacy

Name: Kritagya Manocha

Reg no: 25BAI10186

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Introduction

This report presents the development of basic Digital Literacy skills along with the establishment of an online professional identity by my first year as a Computer Science and Engineering (CSE Core) student at VIT Bhopal. The main goal was to demonstrate efficient use of new-age digital tools (e.g., using Canva for visual communication & Google Forms to collect data) and to create a technical foundation through sites such as GitHub and HackerRank.

In addition to technical execution, the project analysed the importance of Digital Ethics and Cybersecurity. By analysing how professionals communicate through formal emails, and accessing the dangers of UPI fraud; I now understand how to navigate my way safely and professionally through the digital space. This report will detail the specific tasks I have accomplished, the platforms I have used for developing my career, and my thoughts about the habits I must continue to develop to keep my digital footprint secure and uphold my integrity as I complete my degree from 2025-2029.

Task 1 – Write Up

I used Canva to create an educational graphic called “Digital Literacy” which visually represents what digital literacy is, what are some productivity tools (e.g. Notion, Google Docs), and what five best practices for safe internet usage are. I placed it in a clean and green layout with speech bubbles and character illustrations, in order to engage and entice a non-technical audience.

In terms of the whole design process, I found that the concept of visual hierarchy was the most interesting challenge for me to have to work through. This is because I wanted to emphasise the “Safe Internet Practices” part of the design as its own component but at the same time didn’t want to clutter the “Useful Digital Tools” part of the design. As such, learning to balance text with white space allowed me to understand that the way in which I communicate digitally was just as reliant upon the kind of information I communicate as it is reliant on how easily the receiver of the information can consume it. This was a valuable exercise that has assisted me in developing my ability to convert complex topics into visually appealing and actionable data.

Task 2 – Write up

I created a professional account for GitHub, LinkedIn and Stack Overflow. GitHub has been used as an industry standard for version control, LinkedIn is the industry standard for networking with former students and recruiters and Stack Overflow is the industry's go-to source for solving code issues and sharing/learning complex programming theory with a global developer community.

As I progress through my 4-year degree program, I will use these tools strategically. My goal is to record my lab work in GitHub and keep track of my certifications in LinkedIn during my first year. By my third year, I hope to have contributed to one or more open-source projects on GitHub and will post about my experiences after any internships on LinkedIn. Stack Overflow will evolve into a resource that I will use as a reference for future projects and as a place where I will help others solve complex coding problems -- ultimately demonstrating that I've grown technically as well as mastered the core concepts of computer science before I graduate in 2029.

Task 3 – Write Up

Throughout this assignment, I've developed administrative and technical skill sets with both Google Forms and HackerRank. For example, I built a "Digital Literacy Quiz" use Google Forms that contained multiple choice and short answer questions to measure user knowledge relating to password security and suspicious links. In addition, I have used HackerRank to improve my fundamental programming logic by solving various challenges involving the use of standard input and output, as well as successfully passing test cases for simple arithmetic frequently evaluated within a controlled compiler.

These platforms are going to greatly help me throughout my academic career. I have mastered the use of Google Forms, which will allow me to collect data for both research and survey projects in a much more efficient manner. Similarly, I have spent a large amount of time using HackerRank to prepare for both my core programming classes and my competitive coding goals. Using HackerRank will improve my ability to think algorithmically while providing me experience working with the same automated testing environments that I will be required to work within for both technical interviews and academic assessments. Ultimately, Google Forms and HackerRank represent the connection between the theoretical portion and the practical aspect of learning in the CSE curriculum.

Task 4 – Write Up

Digital communication is fundamental to being successful at work. I examined how one wrong "reply all" led to confidential information being sent to an entire organization, leading me to recognize that poor digital etiquette can result in the loss of privacy and a damaged reputation. To help reduce the potential for errors in the future, I practiced writing two types of professional emails; one request to a professor for an extension on an assignment and another email to an internship coordinator. I ensured I adhered to formal guidelines such as using clear subject lines, professional greetings, and being brief and to the point.

After completing this project, I have learned that part of professional communication requires a high degree of intentionality and that by using the "Do's and Don'ts" associated with digital communications, such as confirming recipients of an email prior to sending it and evaluating the content of the email for appropriateness, I can maintain my professional image. Additionally, I have come to understand that digital literacy involves more than just a skill of using technology; it is a social responsibility to respect the privacy of users and to be courteous in every interaction with others through technology.

Task 5 – Write Up

What surprised me most during my research was the deceptive simplicity of UPI fraud. I was unaware of how attackers use "QR code scams" to trick users into believing they are receiving money when they are actually authorizing a payment. Learning that many victims are targeted through a false sense of urgency—such as claims that their account will be frozen—made me realize how much cybercrime relies on psychological manipulation rather than just technical hacking.

As a result of this project, I will personally change my habit of saving passwords in my browser and using simple, repetitive codes. I have committed to using unique, complex passwords for every account and enabling Two-Factor Authentication (2FA) across all my financial and academic platforms. I will also make it a rule to never scan a QR code from an unverified source, ensuring that my digital transactions remain secure.

Conclusion

The project will allow me to have a full understanding of digital literacy in today's engineering field. In addition to basic tools, it is critical for professionals to develop and manage their professional digital reputation, on sites such as GitHub and LinkedIn, as well as develop habits to avoid UPI and phishing scams by keeping their online presence secure. Building these skills at the beginning of my CSE program at VIT Bhopal has laid a solid foundation for my success in both academics and professionalism. I now have the ability to communicate well, build secure systems, and move through the digital world with confidence and caution.

References

- Canva.com: Graphic design tool used to create the infographic in Task 1.
- Google Forms: Created the digital literacy quiz in Task 3.
- HackerRank: A competitive programming site used to practice technical skills for Task 3.
- GitHub, LinkedIn, and Stack Overflow: Online professional networking and version control sites referenced in Task 2.
- National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal (India): Reference/link to the National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal [cybercrime.gov.in] and Helpline 1930 for Task 5.
- Social Media and Professional Communication Guidelines: Documents utilized for projects created for Tasks 4 and 5.